

► **440s BCE**

PARTHENON

Its architects decided to make their temple to the goddess Athena the most impressive in Ancient Greece, and today it is one of the great monuments of the ancient world. The Parthenon has many columns, and is decorated with carved panels and a sculpture frieze.



THE PARTHENON,
ATHENS, GREECE

► **80 CE**

COLOSSEUM

This was the greatest amphitheatre in Ancient Rome. As many as 50,000 people gathered here to watch dramas, gruesome gladiator battles, and amazing spectacles. In the arena were passages, trapdoors, and hidden lifts to allow animals and men to appear from beneath the ground.



THE COLOSSEUM,
ROME, ITALY

► **537 CE**

HAGIA SOPHIA

The cathedral church of Constantinople (now Istanbul), was the largest in the world for 1,000 years. It is famous for its massive dome, and for the ornate mosaics and marble pillars inside. Today, Hagia Sophia is a museum.



HAGIA SOPHIA,
ISTANBUL, TURKEY

► **1113**

ANGKOR WAT

Meaning "City of Temples", Angkor Wat is the largest temple complex in the world. It was built to symbolize the home of the Hindu gods, Mount Meru. Its five towers represent the five peaks of the mountain, the walls its mountain ranges, and the moat the ocean.



ANGKOR WAT, SIEM REAP,
CAMBODIA

◀ **1609**

BLUE MOSQUE

This mosque was built as an Islamic place of worship that would match the brilliance of the Hagia Sophia cathedral. Its design mixes traditional Islamic and Byzantine Christian architecture. It is named for its blue-tiled interior.



BLUE MOSQUE,
ISTANBUL, TURKEY

◀ **1552**

ST BASIL'S CATHEDRAL

Built under the reign of Ivan the Terrible, this cathedral was designed to look like the flames of a bonfire rising up to the sky. It is famous for its unique, colourful, and ornate appearance.



ST BASIL'S CATHEDRAL,
MOSCOW, RUSSIA

◀ **1406**

TEMPLE OF HEAVEN

This temple complex is intended to symbolize Heaven and Earth. Its most important building is the Hall of Prayer for Good Harvests, where sacred ceremonies were conducted by the Ancient Chinese emperors.



THE HALL OF PRAYER FOR GOOD
HARVESTS, BEIJING, CHINA

◀ **1333**

HIMEJI CASTLE

Also known as White Heron Castle, Himeji is Japan's largest and best preserved castle. It was built as a fortress, and its multiple moats, fortified gates, and winding passages were designed to confuse and exhaust intruders.



HIMEJI CASTLE,
JAPAN

◀ **1238**

ALHAMBRA PALACE

A palace and fortress built by Moorish (North African Muslim) kings of southern Spain, the Alhambra was designed to represent Paradise on Earth. There are enclosed landscaped gardens, and the palace is lavishly decorated.



THE ALHAMBRA,
GRANADA, SPAIN

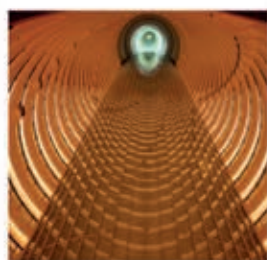
► **1994**

JIN MAO TOWER

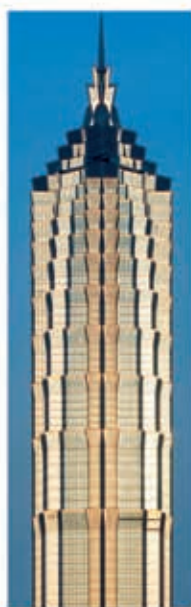
Traditional Chinese and modern Western architectural styles are combined in this Shanghai skyscraper. Each tier flares outwards at its top like a pagoda-style roof. The tower is covered in glass and designed to be wind and earthquake resistant. There is a swimming pool on the 57th floor.



THE GUGGENHEIM
AND SURROUNDING
BUILDINGS



INSIDE THE JIN
MAO TOWER



JIN MAO TOWER,
SHANGHAI, CHINA

► **2004**

BURJ KHALIFA

With 163 floors, Burj Khalifa is the world's tallest building. It is topped with a spiral minaret, like those on mosques. Its 24,348 windows are machine-cleaned, but the top of the spire is cleaned by hand, with the workers dangling from ropes.



BURJ KHALIFA, DUBAI,
UNITED ARAB EMIRATES

TOP 10 TALLEST SKYSCRAPERS

A skyscraper is a building used for offices, homes, or hotels that is higher than 150 m (450 ft).

